Epistemic tiers and their tests

Tier	Design	Quantity	Decision context
Tier 3 Computational	Protocols 2–3	Human model comparison; anticipation and precision-gain pathway	Prediction-specific model evidence; a single nonsignificant test is not framework falsification.
Tier 2 Information-theoretic	Protocol 1	Cardiac gating and behavioral Weibull shape k; distinct from intrinsic sigmoid gain.	Pred 1.E: 95% interval lower ≥10 AND ΔAIC >10; opposing or intermediate outcomes remain indeterminate.
Tier 1 Thermodynamic	Protocol 4; matched calibration	State × load interactions; κ remains uncalibrated.	Signed 15% d′ margin and registered evidence; covariate adjustment is not metabolic mediation.

Protocol 0 gates HEP-dependent claims. Full interval rules and unresolved locks remain in protocols/*.json.